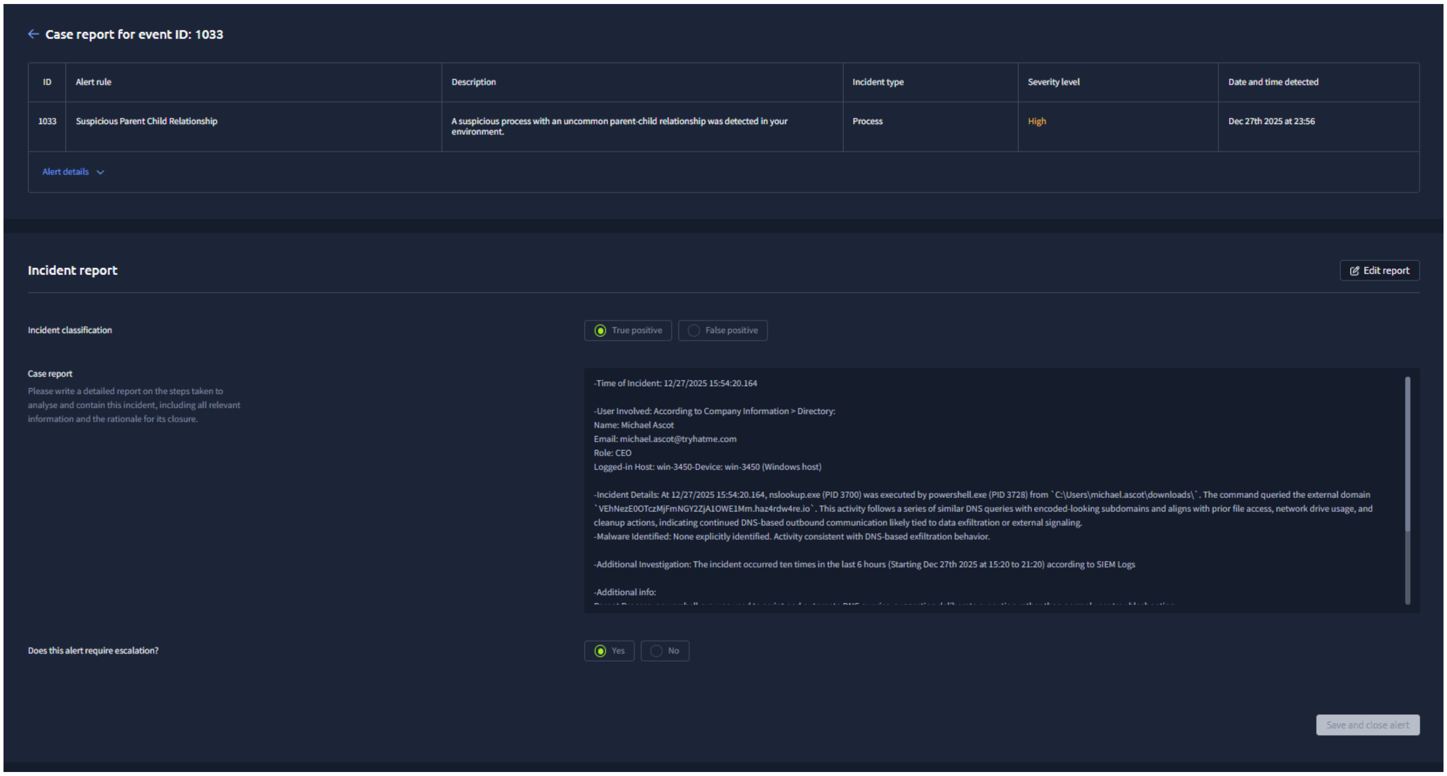
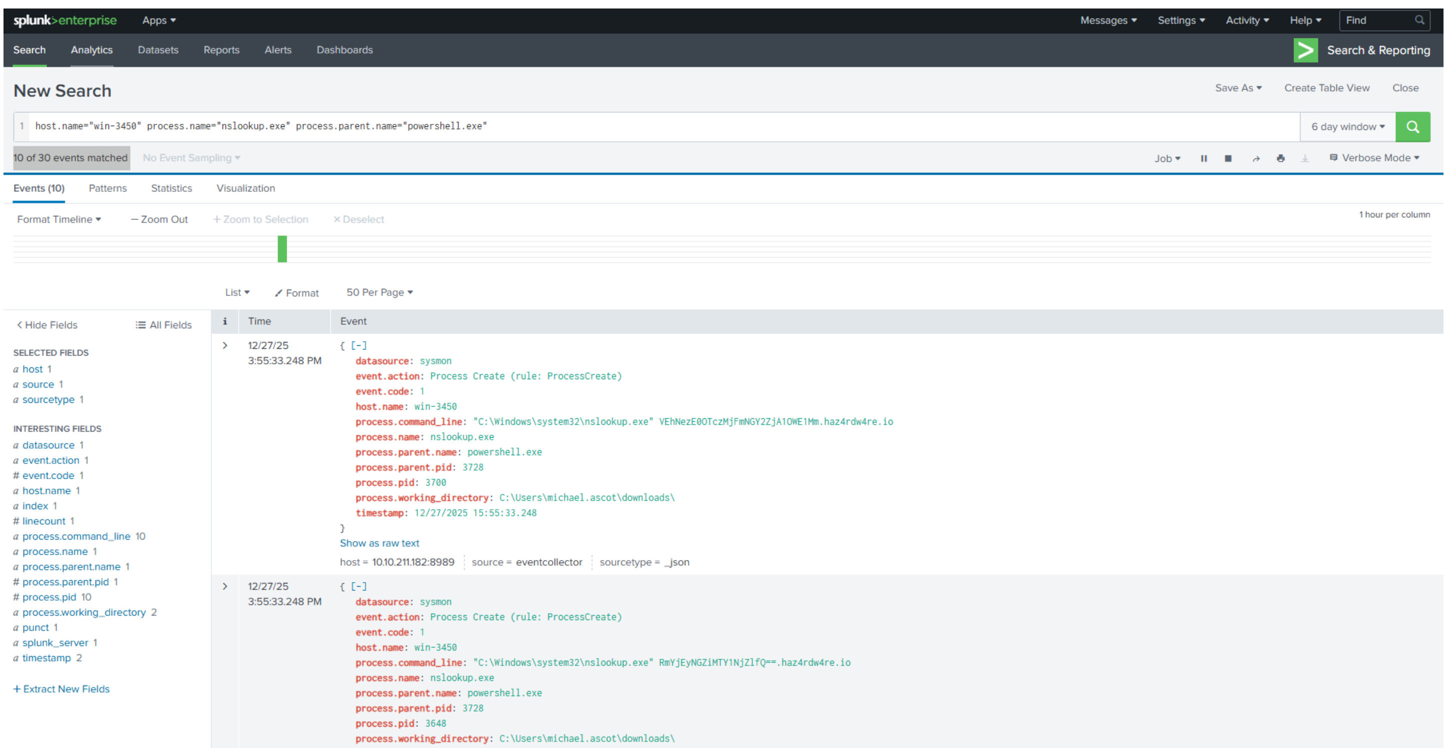


Alert 1033: Process
- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page



SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:20.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:20.164, nslookup.exe (PID 3700) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from `C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\`. The command queried the external domain `VEhNezE0OTczMjFmNGY2ZjA1OWE1Mm.haz4rdw4re.io`. This activity follows a series of similar DNS queries with encoded-looking subdomains and aligns with prior file access, network drive usage, and cleanup actions, indicating continued DNS-based outbound communication likely tied to data exfiltration or external signaling.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Activity consistent with DNS-based exfiltration behavior.

-Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) according to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to script and automate DNS queries, suggesting deliberate execution rather than normal user troubleshooting.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS lookup utility that can be abused to transmit encoded data through DNS requests.

Why This Is Uncommon: Repeated DNS queries with high-entropy subdomains executed via PowerShell, especially following data access activity, are not typical user behavior and strongly indicate covert data transfer techniques.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation